Chronology of the Four Gospels

(Harmony of the Gospels)

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Bible chronology main page

New Testament chronology page

Español

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This document was expanded and made as complete as possible in June, 2020, and several summarized sections were "unpacked", showing each separate parable or teaching. (For background information, colors, other formatting, symbols used, and endnotes see the last three pages.)

From before the Birth of Jesus to the Beginning of his Ministry

		When and Where	Matthew	Mark	Luke	John	
Introduction	Introductory Material			**1:1**	**1:1-4**		1351-52
	The Prelude to John					**1:1-18**	1352
	The genealogies of Jesus	↓ Luke 1:24,26	**1:1-17**		**3:23b-38**		1353-55
The births of John the Baptist and of Jesus Christ	An angel appears to Zechariah	Jerusalem, 15 months before the birth of Jesus			**1:5-25**		1356
	An angel appears to Mary	Nazareth, 9 months before the birth of Jesus			**1:26-38**		1357
	Mary visits Elizabeth	Judea (Luke 1:39) ↑ Luke 1:31,36			**1:39-56**		
	Birth of John the Baptist	Judea, 6 months before the birth of Jesus			**1:57-80**		1358
	Joseph finds out Mary is pregnant	Nazareth, after the return of Mary	**1:18-25a**				1359
	Birth of Jesus	Bethlehem, between 6 and 4 B.C.? [1]			**2:1-20**		
	Circumcision of Jesus	8 days old	1:25b		**2:21**		1360
	Presented in the temple	Jerusalem, 40 days old (Lev. 12:4)			**2:22-39a**		
	Visit of the wise men	Jerusalem, Bethlehem	**2:1-12**				1361-62
	Flight to Egypt	Egypt	**2:13-15**				
	Massacre of the Infant Boys	Bethlehem	**2:16-18**				
	Return to Nazareth †	Nazareth, 4 B.C.? [1]	**2:19-23**		2:39b		1363
Jesus' childhood	Early childhood				**2:40**		
	Visit to Jerusalem	12 years old (Luke 2:42)			**2:41-51**		
	Later childhood				**2:52**		

The First Year and a Half of the Ministry of Jesus (the "Year of Preparation")

The start of the ministries of John the Baptist and Jesus	John begins his ministry †	By the river Jordan, latter part of year 26[2]	**3:1-12**	1:2-8	**3:1-18**		1364
	Baptism of Jesus	(Luke 3:23: "Jesus…was about thirty years of age")	**3:13-17**	1:9-11	**3:21-23a**	(1:32-34)	1365
	Temptation of Jesus	In the desert for 40 days	**4:1-11**	1:12-13	**4:1-13**		1366
	John explains his ministry	Bethany on the other side of the Jordan (early 27?)				**1:19-28**	1367
	John proclaims Jesus	the next day				**1:29-34**	
	Initial call of Peter and Andrew[3]	the next day				**1:35-42**	1368
	Call of Philip and Nathanael	the next day				**1:43-51**	
	Jesus changes water into wine	Cana in Galilee, 3 days later (after a 3-day walk)				**2:1-11**	1369
	They all go to Capernaum	"After this… they stayed there for a few days"				**2:12**	
First Passover† of Jesus' Ministry	Jesus clears the temple	Jerusalem, almost Passover, April (year 27)[4]				**2:13-25**	
	Jesus teaches Nicodemus					**3:1-21**	
	Jesus and John the Baptist baptize					**3:22-24**	1370
	John the Baptist tells about Jesus					**3:25-36**	
End of the year	Herod puts John in prison †	December? (year 27) (see John 4:35)	4:12a	1:14a	**3:19-20**	(3:24)	1373
	Jesus leaves for Galilee	"				**4:1-3**	1371, 1373
	The Samaritan woman	Sychar in Samaria (Jesus stays for 2 days) "				**4:4-42**	
Beginning of the Great Galilean Ministry	Jesus arrives in Galilee †	Galilee "	4:12b	1:14b	**4:14-15**	**4:43-45**	1372
	Jesus heals an official's son	Cana in Galilee				**4:46-54**	
	Jesus settles in Capernaum	Capernaum (early 28?)	**4:13-16**				1373
	He begins preaching the kingdom		**4:17**	1:14c-15			
	Rejection in Nazareth	Nazareth, on a Sabbath			**4:16-30**		1374
	"Official" call of the 4 fishermen	Sea of Galilee (Lake Gennesaret)	**4:18-22**	**1:16-20**	[5:1-11]		
	He heals man with unclean spirit	Capernaum, on a Sabbath		**1:21-28**	4:31-37		
	Heals Peter's mother-in-law, others	Capernaum, same day	8:14-17	**1:29-34**	4:38-41		1375
	Jesus prays in a solitary place	The next day, a solitary place		**1:35-38**	4:42-43		
	Jesus travels throughout Galilee	The villages of Galilee (Mark 1:38)	**4:23-25**	1:39	4:44		
	Call of 4 fishermen confirmed	Lake Gennesaret (Sea of Galilee)	[4:18-22]	[1:16-20]	**5:1-11**[5]		1374
	He heals a leper	"one of the towns" (Luke 5:12)	**8:1-4**	1:40-45	5:12-16		1376
	He heals a paralytic	Capernaum, a few days later (Mark 2:1)	**9:1-8**	2:1-12	5:17-26		
	Jesus calls Matthew (Levi)	Sea of Galilee (Lake Gennesaret)	**9:9-13**	2:13-17	5:27-32		1377
	John's disciples ask about fasting †	(John still in prison)	**9:14-17**	2:18-22	5:33-39		

The Second Year of the Ministry of Jesus (the "Year of Popularity")

		When and Where	Matthew	Mark	Luke	John	
Second Passover of Jesus' ministry	He heals a paralytic on the Sabbath	April? [6] (year 28), Jerusalem, Pool of Bethesda				**5:1-47**	1377-79
	Disciples pick grain on the Sabbath	Galilee again, April/May (ripe barley or wheat) [6] †	**12:1-8**	2:23-28	6:1-5		1379
	Jesus heals on the Sabbath		**12:9-14**	3:1-6	6:6-11		
	Jesus heals others	Lake Gennesaret (Sea of Galilee)	**12:15-21**	3:7-12			1380
	Jesus chooses 12 apostles	A mountain near the lake		3:13-19	**6:12-16**		
The Sermon on the Mount: The First Discourse	A crowd gathers	A level place on the same mountain	5:1a		**6:17-19**		
	The beatitudes		**5:1b-12**		6:20-23		1381
	The woes				**6:24-26**		
	"You are the salt of the earth"		**5:13**	[9:50]	[14:34-35]		1382
	"You are the light of the world"		**5:14-16**				
	The fulfillment of the law		**5:17-37**				
	An eye for an eye		**5:38-42**		**6:27-31**		1383
	"Love your enemies"		**5:43-48**		**6:32-36**		
	Giving to the needy		**6:1-4**				
	Prayer		**6:5-8**				
	The Lord's Prayer		**6:9-15**		[11:1-4]		
	Fasting		**6:16-18**				
	Treasure in Heaven		**6:19-21**		[12:32-34]		
	The lamp of the body		**6:22-23**		[11:33-36]		
	No one can serve two masters		**6:24**				
	Do not worry		**6:25-34**		[12:22-31]		1383-85
	Judging others		7:1-5		**6:37-42**		1385
	Do not throw pearls to pigs		**7:6**				
	Ask and it will be given		**7:7-11**		[11:5-13]		
	The golden rule		**7:12**				
	The two gates		**7:13-14**		[13:23-30]		
	A tree and its fruit		**7:15-23**		**6:43-45**		
	The wise and foolish builders		**7:24-27**		**6:46-49**		1386
	The crowds are amazed		**7:28-29**				
The ministry continues	He heals the slave of a centurion	Capernaum	**8:5-13**		**7:1-10**		
	Jesus raises a widow's son	Nain			**7:11-17**		1387
	Jesus and John the Baptist †	(John still in prison)	**11:2-19**		**7:18-35**		
	Jesus anointed by a sinful woman				**7:36-50**		1388
	Jesus travels about	Galilee			**8:1-3**		1389
	Jesus and Beelzebub	Capernaum	**12:22-30**	3:20-27	**11:14-23**		
	Blasphemy against the Holy Spirit		**12:31-37**	3:28-30			
	The sign of Jonah		**12:38-42**		**11:29-32**		
	Temporary reform		**12:43-45**		**11:24-28**		1390
	Who are my brothers?		**12:46-50**	3:31-35	**8:19-21**		
	The lamp of the body		[6:22-23]		**11:33-36**		
	Six woes				**11:37-54**		
Parables: The Kingdom of Heaven Discourse	The sower	beside the lake	**13:1-23**	4:1-20	8:4-15		1394
	The weeds		**13:24-30**				1395
	The lamp			**4:21-25**	8:16-18		1396
	The growing seed			**4:26-29**			
	The mustard seed		**13:31-32**	4:30-32	[13:18-19][7]		
	The yeast		**13:33**		[13:20-21][7]		
	Parable of the weeds explained		**13:36-43**				
	The hidden treasure		**13:44**				
	The pearl		**13:45-46**				1397
	The net		**13:47-52**				
	Parables as fulfillment of prophecy		**13:34-35**	4:33-34			
Miracles	The cost of following Jesus		**8:18-22**		**9:57-62**		
	Jesus calms the storm	Lake Gennesaret (Sea of Galilee)	8:23-27	**4:35-41**	8:22-25		1398
	Heals two demon-possessed men	Gerasa	8:28-34	**5:1-20**	8:26-39		
	A dead girl	Capernaum	9:18-19	**5:21-24a**	8:40-42		1399
	A sick woman		9:20-22	**5:24b-34**	8:43-48		
	Jesus raises Jairus' daughter		9:23-26	**5:35-43**	8:49-56		
	Jesus heals two blind men		**9:27-31**				
	Jesus heals a mute man		**9:32-34**				1400
	Jesus is rejected again	Nazareth, on a Sabbath	13:53-58	**6:1-6a**			

		When and Where	Matthew	Mark	Luke	John	
Sending the 12 apostles: The Missionary Discourse	The laborers are few	"all the towns and villages" / "from village to village"	**9:35-38**	6:6b			
	Jesus calls together the twelve	Capernaum?	**10:1-4**	**6:7**	9:1-2		1401
	He instructs the apostles		**10:5-15**	6:8-11	9:3-5		
	Shrewd but innocent		**10:16-33**		[12:1-12]		
	Conflict and sacrifice		**10:34-38**		[12:49-53]		1402
	Whoever loses his life will find it		**10:39**		[17:33]		
	"He who receives you receives me"		**10:40-42**				
	The apostles are sent out		**11:1**	6:12-13	**9:6**		
The death of John	The death of John the Baptist †	Machaerus (early 29?)	**14:3-12**	**6:17-29**	**(9:9)**		
	Herod wonders about Jesus	Perea	14:1-2	**6:14-16**	**9:7-9**		1403

The Third Year of the Ministry of Jesus (the "Year of Opposition")

Miracles and Multitudes (Third Passover† of Jesus' ministry)	The apostles return	Capernaum?		**6:30**	**9:10a**		1404
	Withdraw by boat to solitary place	Near Bethsaida (Luke 9:10), south of it?	14:13a	**6:31-32**	**9:10b**	6:1	
	The crowds follow		14:13b	**6:33**	**9:11a**	6:2	
	Jesus teaches and heals the people	On a hill (John 6:3), near Passover, April (year 29)	14:14	**6:34**	**9:11b**	6:3-4	
	He feeds the five thousand	Towards evening, "green grass" (Mark 6:39)[8]	14:15-21	**6:35-44**	9:12-17	**6:5-13**	
	He avoids being made king					**6:14-15**	
	He sends the disciples away by boat		14:22a	**6:45a**		**6:16-17a**	
	He dismisses the crowd		14:22b	**6:45b**			
	He goes up mountainside to pray		14:23a	**6:46**			
	Evening comes, disciples struggle	Evening	14:23b-24	**6:47-48a**		**6:17b-18**	
	Jesus walks on the water	Fourth watch, after 3 a.m.	14:25-26	**6:48b-50a**		**6:19**	
	"Don't be afraid"		14:27	**6:50b**		**6:20**	
	Peter walks on the water		**14:28-31**				
	Jesus calms storm, enters boat		**14:32-33**	**6:51-52**		6:21	
	Miracles in Gennesaret	Town of Gennesaret	14:34-36	**6:53-56**			1405
	The bread of life	Capernaum, the next day				**6:22-71**	1405-6
	Jesus condemns traditions of men		15:1-9	**7:1-13**			1407
	True uncleanness		**15:10-20**	**7:14-23**			
	End of **Great Galilean Ministry**[9]					**7:1**	1408
Travels throughout Galilee and surrounding regions	The Canaanite woman	Tyre and Sidon	**15:21-28**	**7:24-30**			
	He heals a deaf mute (and others)	Sea of Galilee, southeast shore (Decapolis)	**15:29-31**	**7:31-37**			
	He feeds the four thousand	3 days after leaving Tyre and Sidon	15:32-39	**8:1-10**			1409
	The demand for a sign	Dalmanutha / Magadan / Magdala	**16:1-4**	**8:11-13**			
	Warnings about Jewish leaders		**16:5-12**	**8:14-21**			
	The blind man near Bethsaida	Bethsaida		**8:22-26**			1410
Preparation of the apostles for the end	The confession of Peter	Caesarea Philippi	**16:13-20**	8:27-30	9:18-20		1411
	Jesus predicts his death		**16:21-23**	8:31-33	9:21-22		
	True discipleship		16:24-27	**8:34-38**	9:23-26		
	The kingdom of God coming soon		16:28	**9:1**	9:27		
	The transfiguration	6 days later (Mat. 17:1, Mark 9:2), Mount Hermon?	**17:1-9**	9:2-10	9:28-36		
	Elijah and John the Baptist		**17:10-13**	9:11-13			1412
	He heals a boy with an evil spirit	The next day (Luke 9:37), near the mountain	**17:14-18**	**9:14-29**	9:37-43a		
	Faith as small as a mustard seed		**17:19-21**		[17:5-6]		
	He again predicts his death	Galilee	17:22-23	**9:30-32**	9:43b-45		1413
	The coin from the fish	Capernaum	**17:24-27**				
The Discourse on the Church	Greatest in kingdom of heaven		**18:1-2**	**9:33-36**	**9:46-47**		
	Become like little children		**18:3-4**				
	Welcoming a little child		**18:5**	**9:37**	**9:48**		
	Deeds in the name of Jesus[10]			**9:38-41**	9:49-50		1414
	Causing a child to sin		**18:6-7**	**9:42**	[17:1-2]		1413
	Warning about temptation		**18:8-9**	**9:43-50**			1414
	Parable of the lost sheep		**18:10-14**		[15:1-7]		1413
	Discipline in the church		**18:15-17**				
	He gives authority to the apostles		**18:18-20**				
	Forgiveness		**18:21-22**		[17:3-4]		
	Parable of the indebted servants		**18:23-35**				
In Jerusalem for the Feast of Tabernacles†	Jesus' brothers	Capernaum, September or October (year 29)				**7:2-9**	1416
	Jesus goes to the Feast in secret	Jerusalem				**7:10-13**	
	Controversy about Jesus					**7:14-52**	1416-17
	The woman caught in adultery	in the temple				**7:53-8:11**	1418
	Various teachings					**8:12-59**	1418-20
	He heals the man born blind	on a Sabbath				**9:1-10:21**	1420-22

		When and Where	Matthew	Mark	Luke	John	
Ministry while traveling from Galilee to Judea	Jesus leaves Galilee		19:1a	10:1a	**9:51**		1423
	Ten healed of leprosy	Border between Galilee and Samaria			**17:11-19**		
	The opposition of the Samaritans	Samaria			**9:52-56**		
	Jesus sends the seventy-two	(Location unknown, not Galilee)			**10:1-11**		
	Woe on unrepentant towns		**11:20-24**		**10:12-16**		
	The seventy-two return	some time later			**10:17-20**		1424
	God's revelation		11:25-27		**10:21-24**		
	"I will give you rest"		**11:28-30**				
	Parable of the Good Samaritan				**10:25-37**		
	With Mary and Martha	Bethany near Jerusalem			**10:38-42**		1425
	The Lord's Prayer	"a certain place", probably still around Jerusalem	[6:9-15]		**11:1-4**		
	Ask and it will be given		[7:7-11]		**11:5-13**		
In Jerusalem	Feast of Dedication (Hanukkah) †	Jerusalem, November or December (year 29)				**10:22-39**	1426
The Ministry in Perea[11]	To Perea[11]	Perea ("the region of Judea beyond the Jordan")	19:1b-2	10:1b		**10:40-42**	1423, 1426
	Warnings and Encouragements		[10:16-33]		**12:1-12**		1391
	Parable of the rich fool				**12:13-21**		
	Do not worry		[6:25-34]		**12:22-31**		1392
	Treasure in Heaven		[6:19-21]		**12:32-34**		
	Watchfulness				**12:35-48**		
	Not peace but division		[10:34-38]		**12:49-53**		1393
	Interpreting the times				**12:54-59**		
	Repent or perish				**13:1-9**		
	Crippled woman healed on Sabbath	a synagogue, on a Sabbath			**13:10-17**		1394
	Parable of the mustard seed		[13:31-32]	[4:30-32]	**13:18-19**[7]		
	Parable of the yeast		[13:33]		**13:20-21**[7]		
	Heading towards Jerusalem	Towns & villages, journeying toward Jerusalem			**13:22**		1427
	The narrow door		[7:13-14]		**13:23-30**		
	Jesus warned about Herod				**13:31-33**		
	Jesus at a Pharisee's House	on a Sabbath			**14:1-14**		1428
	Parable of the Great Banquet				**14:15-24**		
	The cost of being a disciple				**14:25-33**		
	Salt without taste is worthless		[5:13]	[9:50]	**14:34-35**		1429
	Parable of the lost sheep		[18:10-14]		**15:1-7**		
	Parable of the lost coin				**15:8-10**		
	Parable of the lost son				**15:11-32**		
	Parable of the shrewd manager				**16:1-15**		1430
	Additional teachings				**16:16-18**		
	The rich man and Lazarus				**16:19-31**		1431
	Causing little ones to sin		[18:6-7]	[9:42]	**17:1-2**		1414
	Forgiveness		[18:21-22]		**17:3-4**		1413
	Faith as small as a mustard seed		[17:19-21]		**17:5-6**		1412
	Unworthy servants				**17:7-10**		1413
	Coming of the kingdom of God		[24:23-27]	[13:21-23]	**17:20-25**		1431
	As in the days of Noah		[24:37-39]		**17:26-27**		
	As in the days of Lot				**17:28-32**		
	Whoever loses his life will keep it		[10:39]		**17:33**		
	Some taken, some left		[24:40-43]		**17:34-36**		
	The corpse and the vultures		[24:28]		**17:37**		
	Parable of Persistent Widow				**18:1-8**		1432
	Parable of Pharisee & Tax Collector				**18:9-14**		
	Divorce		**19:3-12**	10:2-12			1436
	Jesus blesses the children		19:13-15	**10:13-16**	18:15-17		
	The rich young man		19:16-22	**10:17-22**	18:18-23		1437
	The love of riches		19:23-26	**10:23-27**	18:24-27		
	Leaving the things of the world		**19:27-30**	10:28-31	18:28-30		
	Parable of workers in vineyard		**20:1-16**				
Return to Judea to raise Lazarus[12]	Jesus hears that Lazarus is sick	Still in Perea				**11:1-16**	1433-34
	Jesus raises Lazarus	Bethany near Jerusalem				**11:17-53**	1434-35
	He withdraws again	Ephraim				**11:54**	1435
The final journey	Jesus again predicts his death	Road to Jerusalem	20:17-19	**10:32-34**	**18:31-34**		
	The mother of James and John		**20:20-23**	**10:35-40**			
	Humility		20:24-28	**10:41-45**			1438
	Heals blind Bartimaeus and another	Jericho	**20:29-34**	**10:46-52**	**18:35-43**[13]		1438
	Zacchaeus comes to Jesus	"			**19:1-10**		1438
	Parable of the ten minas	"			**19:11-27**		1439

		When and Where	Matthew	Mark	Luke	John
	He goes on towards Jerusalem				**19:28**	
	The plan to arrest Jesus	Jerusalem, April, shortly before the Passover (year 30)				**11:55-57**

The Last Week of the Ministry of Jesus

(thick line: new day) (thick red line: text indicates new day)

Saturday†	Mary anoints Jesus[14]	Bethany, 6 days before the Passover (Saturday) †	**26:6-13**	**14:3-9**		**12:1-8**	
	The plan to kill Lazarus					**12:9-11**	1440
Palm Sunday†	The people come out to meet Jesus	Palm Sunday				**12:12-13**	
	Jesus sends for the donkey's colt	passing the Mount of Olives	**21:1-7**	**11:1-7**	**19:29-35**	**12:14-16**	1441
	The Triumphal Entry	Jerusalem	21:8-9	**11:8-10**	**19:36-40**		
	Predicts destruction of Jerusalem				**19:41-44**		
	Jesus is recognized		**21:10-11**			**12:17-19**	
	Return to Bethany	Bethany	21:17	**11:11**			
Monday†	The fig tree without fruit	On the way	21:18-19a	**11:12-14**			1442
	Jesus clears the temple	Jerusalem, in the temple	21:12-13	**11:15-17**	19:45-46		
	His enemies continue planning			**11:18**	**19:47-48**		
	The children praise Jesus		**21:14-16**				
	They go out of the city	To where??		**11:19**			1443
	daily plan, morning and evening				**(21:37-38)**		1456
Tuesday morning†	The fig tree dries up	On the way	**21:19b-22**	**11:20-26**			1444
	The authority of Jesus questioned	In Jerusalem	21:23-27	**11:27-33**	20:1-8		
	Parable of the two sons		**21:28-32**				
	Parable of the tenants		21:33-41	**12:1-9**	**20:9-16**		1445
	The stone the builders rejected		**21:42-44**	12:10-11	20:17-18		
	Leaders are offended		**21:45-46**	12:12	20:19		
	Parable of the wedding banquet		**22:1-14**				
	Question about taxes		**22:15-22**	12:13-17	**20:20-26**		1446
	Question about the resurrection		**22:23-33**	12:18-27	20:27-38		
	The greatest commandment		22:34-40	**12:28-34**	20:39-40		
	Whose son is the Christ?		**22:41-46**	**12:35-37**	20:41-44		1447
	Jesus condemns pride		**23:1-12**	12:38-40	20:45-47		
	Seven woes		**23:13-36**				
	Lament about Jerusalem		**23:37-39**		13:34-35[15]		1447, 1427
	The example of the poor widow			**12:41-44**	21:1-4		1448
Teaching About the End of the Age: The Olivet Discourse	The temple will be destroyed	Leaving the temple	24:1-2	**13:1-2**	21:5-6		1449
	The disciples ask questions		**24:3**	**13:3-4**	21:7		
	"See that no one leads you astray"		**24:4-5**	**13:5-6**	**21:8**		
	Wars and Persecution		**24:6-14**	**13:7-13**	**21:9-19**		
	Abomination and Tribulation		**24:15-22**	**13:14-20**	**21:20-24**		
	False Christs		**24:23-27**	**13:21-23**	[17:20-25]		
	The corpse and the vultures		**24:28**		[17:37]		
	The coming of the Son of Man		**24:29-31**	**13:24-27**	**21:25-28**		
	The Lesson of the Fig Tree		**24:32-35**	**13:28-31**	**21:29-33**		
	No One Knows That Day or Hour		**24:36**	13:32			
	As in the days of Noah		**24:37-39**		[17:26-27]		
	Some taken, some left		**24:40-43**		[17:34-36]		
	Keep watch		**24:44-51**	**13:33-37**	**21:34-36**		
	Parable of the ten virgins		**25:1-13**				
	Parable of the talents		**25:14-30**				1452
	The sheep and the goats		**25:31-46**				1453
Tuesday afternoon	Jesus again predicts his death[16]					**12:20-36a**	1442
	Completion of his public ministry[16]					**12:36b**	1243
	He reminds disciples of crucifixion	Two days before Passover/Unleavened Bread †	**26:1-2**				1454
	The plot against Jesus		**26:3-5**	14:1-2	22:1-2		
	Judas agrees to betray Jesus		**26:14-16**	14:10-11	**22:3-6**		
Summary of Ministry[16]	Unbelief of the Jews					**12:37-43**	1456
	Summary of Jesus' message					**12:44-50**	
Wednesday[16]	(Jesus rests?)						
Thursday[16]	Preparations for the Lord's Supper	first day of Passover/ Unleavened Bread †	26:17-19	14:12-16	**22:7-13**		1457

		When and Where	Matthew	Mark	Luke	John	
The Lord's Supper (Fourth Passover of Jesus' ministry)	They recline at the table	The upper room, night †	**26:20**	**14:17**	**22:14**		1458
	The importance of this supper				**22:15-16**		
	Jesus washes his disciples' feet[17]					**13:1-17**	
	Jesus talks about his betrayer		26:21	14:18	**22:21-22**	**13:18-21**	1459
	They ask who it is[18]		**26:22-25**	14:19-21	22:23	**13:22-25**	
	Jesus identifies the betrayer					**13:26-27a**	
	Judas leaves					**13:27b-30**	
	The new commandment					**13:31-35**	
	Institution of the Supper: the bread		26:26	14:22	**22:19**	1 Co. 11:23-24	1458
	Institution of the Supper: the wine		**26:27-28**	**14:23-24**	22:20	1 Co. 11:25	
	Jesus will not drink wine again		**26:29**	**14:25**	**22:17-18**		
	Greatness through service				**22:24-30**		
	Jesus predicts Peter's denial				**22:31-34**	**13:36-38**	1460
	Jesus, the way to the Father					**14:1-14**	
	The promise of the Holy Spirit					**14:15-31a**	
	Purse, bag, and sword				**22:35-38**		1461
	They go out to the Mount of Olives		**26:30**	**14:26**	**22:39**	14:31b	
	Jesus predicts Peter's denial		**26:31-35**	14:27-31			
	"I am the true vine"					**15:1-17**	1462
	The hatred of the world					**15:18-16:4**	1463
	The work of the Holy Spirit					**16:5-15**	
	"Your sorrow will turn into joy"					**16:16-24**	
	"I have overcome the world"					**16:25-33**	1464
	The high priestly prayer					**17:1-26**	
In Gethsemane	They arrive at Gethsemane	Gethsemane	26:36-38	**14:32-34**	22:40	**18:1**	1465
	Jesus prays in agony		26:39	14:35-36	**22:41-45**		1466
	Jesus prays the second time		**26:40-42**	14:37-39	22:46		
	Jesus prays the third time		**26:43-46**	14:40-42			
	Judas betrays Jesus		**26:47-50**	14:43-45	22:47-48	18:2-3	
	Jesus asks for safety of disciples					**18:4-9**	
	Peter cuts off Malchus's ear		**26:51-54**	14:46-47	**22:49-51**	**18:10-11**	
	Jesus questions manner of arrest		26:55-56a	14:48-49	**22:52-53**		1467
	Jesus is arrested, disciples flee		**26:56b**	14:50		**18:12**	
	A young man flees naked (Mark??)			**14:51-52**			
Trial before the Jewish Authorities	To Annas' and Caiaphas' house[19]	Jerusalem	**26:57**	**14:53**	22:54a		
	Before Annas first					**18:13-14**	
	Peter follows into the courtyard[18]		**26:58**	**14:54**	22:54b	**18:15-16**	
	Peter denies Jesus the first time		26:69-71a	**14:66-68a**	22:55-57	**18:17-18**	1467, 1468
	A rooster crows (the first time)			**14:68b**			
	Trial before Annas					**18:19-24**	1468
	Trial before Caiaphas & Sanhedrin		26:59-66	**14:55-64**			
	They beat and mock Jesus		26:67-68	14:65	**22:63-65**		
	Peter denies Jesus the second time	"A little later" (Luke 22:58)	**26:71b-72**	**14:69-70a**	22:58	**18:25**	
	Peter denies Jesus the third time	"About an hour later" (Luke 22:59)	**26:73-74a**	**14:70b-71**	**22:59-60a**	**18:26-27a**	1469
	A rooster crows (the second time)		26:74b	**14:72a**	**22:60b**	18:27b	
	Jesus looks at Peter, who weeps		26:75	**14:72b**	**22:61-62**		
Friday†,[16] early morning	The Sanhedrin condemns Jesus		**27:1**	15:1a	**22:66-71**		
	Judas commits suicide		**27:3-10**			Acts 1:18-19	
Trial before Pilate	Before Pilate	The Praetorium	**27:2**	15:1b	**23:1-2**	**18:28-32**	1470
	Pilate interrogates Jesus		**27:11-14**	15:2-5	23:3-4	**18:33-38**	
	Before Herod				**23:5-12**		1471
	Message from Pilate's wife		**27:19**				
	Pilate wants to release him				**23:13-16**		
	Jesus or Barrabas		27:15-18	**15:6-10**	23:17	18:39	
	The crowd chooses Barrabas		**27:20-21**	**15:11**	**23:18-19**	**18:40**	1472
	"Crucify him!"		**27:22-23**	15:12-14	**23:20-23**		
	Crown of thorns		**27:27-30**	15:16-19		**19:1-3**	
	Pilate tries to release him	6:00 a.m. †				**19:4-15**	
	Pilate washes his hands		**27:24-25**				1473
	Barrabas is released		27:26	15:15	**23:24-25**	19:16	
	They lead him out to crucify him	In the Via Dolorosa	27:31	**15:20**		**19:17**	
	Simon of Cyrene		27:32	**15:21**	23:26		
	The women weep for him				**23:27-31**		

		When and Where	Matthew	Mark	Luke	John	
The Crucifixion	Jesus is crucified	Golgotha ("Place of the Skull"), 9:00 a.m. (Mk. 15:25)	**27:33-35a**	**15:22-24a**	**23:33**	19:18	1474
	"Father, forgive them"[20]				**23:34a**		
	they cast lots for his clothes		27:35b-36	15:24b	23:34b	**19:23-24**	
	It was the third hour (9 a.m.)	9:00 a.m. †		**15:25**			
	The written notice above his head		27:37	15:26	23:38	**19:19-22**	
	They crucify two robbers with him		**27:38**	**15:27**	23:32		
	Everyone insults him		**27:39-44**	15:28-32	23:35		
	The soldiers insult him				**23:36-37**		
	"You will be with me in paradise"				**23:39-43**		
	"Here is your mother"[18]					**19:25-27**	1475
	Darkness over all the land	12:00 noon †	27:45	15:33	**23:44**-45a		
	"Why have you forsaken me?"	3:00 p.m. †	**27:46-47**	**15:34-35**			
	"I am thirsty"		27:48	15:36a		**19:28-29**	
	"Let's see if Elijah comes"		**27:49**	**15:36b**			
	"It is finished"					**19:30a**	
	"into your hands I commit spirit"				**23:46a**		
	The death of Jesus		**27:50**	15:37	**23:46b**	**19:30b**	
	Miraculous events		**27:51-53**	15:38	23:45b		
	The centurion believes		**27:54**	**15:39**	23:47		
	The crowd is amazed				**23:48**		
	The women and his followers		**27:55-56**	**15:40-41**	23:49		
	Jesus' side is pierced[18]					**19:31-37**	
Jesus is buried	Joseph of Arimathea asks for body	Late afternoon †	27:57-58	**15:42-45**	23:50-52	19:38	1476
	Jesus is buried	Before nightfall †	**27:59-60**	15:46	23:53-54	19:39-42	
	The women observe		27:61	**15:47**	**23:55**		
	The women prepare spices				**23:56a**		
Saturday†[16]	The guard before the tomb		**27:62-66**				
	The women rest				**23:56b**		
	The women buy more spices	After the Sabbath. † Saturday evening?		**16:1**			

The 40 Days From the Resurrection to the Ascension

The resurrection of Jesus Christ (Sunday)†	The women go to the tomb	Mary Magdalene, Mary mother of James, Salome; still dark	28:1	**16:2-3**	24:1	20:1a	1478
	The stone is rolled back		**28:2-4**				
	The women see that it is!			**16:4**	24:2	20:1b	
	They do not find the body				**24:3**		
	They see the angels			16:5	**24:4**		
	Angels proclaim the resurrection		**28:5-6**	16:6	24:5-6a		
	"Remember how he told you"				**24:6b-8**		
	"go quickly and tell his disciples"		**28:7**	**16:7**			
	At first they say nothing out of fear			**16:8**			
	Then they run to tell his disciples		**28:8a**				
	Mary M. runs ahead, unbelieving					**20:2a**	
	Mary M. tells Peter and John[18]					**20:2b**	
	Peter and John see the tomb				24:12	**20:3-10**	
	Jesus appears to Mary Magdalene			16:9		**20:11-17**	
	Jesus appears to the (other) women		**28:8b-10**				1479
	The report of the guard		**28:11-15**				
	Women tell news to disciples			16:10-11	**24:9-11**	20:18	
	Jesus appears to Peter	when?	1 Co. 15:5a		**(24:34)**		
	Jesus appears to Cleopas & another	afternoon, road to Emmaus (7 miles, 2-hour walk)		16:12	**24:13-27**		
	Jesus reveals himself to them	"nearly evening", Emmaus			**24:28-32**		1480
	They return to Jerusalem	(2-hour walk back)		16:13	**24:33-35**		
	Jesus appears to the disciples	Sunday evening †	1 Co. 15:5b	16:14	**24:36-43**	20:19-20	
	The apostles receive authority					**20:21-23**	
	He opens their minds to understand				**24:44-48**		
Later	Incredulity of Thomas					**20:24-25**	1481
The next Sunday	Jesus appears to Thomas	same house, one week after his resurrection †				**20:26-29**	

		When and Where	Matthew	Mark	Luke	John	
Later	Jesus appears to seven disciples[18]	Galilee, Sea of Tiberias				**21:1-24**	
	Appearance to the Eleven in Galilee	a mountain in Galilee	**28:16-17**				1482
	The Great Commission		**28:18-20**	16:15-16			
	Signs			**16:17-18**			
	Appearance to the 500	when?	**1 Co. 15:6**				
	Appearance to James	when?	**1 Co. 15:7a**				
	Summary of his appearances	over a period of 40 days †				**Acts 1:3**	
The ascension (40 days after the resurrection)	Last instructions	Jerusalem?	1 Co. 15:7b		**24:49**	**Acts 1:4-8**	1483
	The ascension	Bethany, near Jerusalem		16:19	**24:50-51**	**Acts 1:9**	
	He will come back as he went					**Acts 1:10-11**	
	They return to Jerusalem				24:52-53	**Acts 1:12-14**	
Final Comments	Incomplete but selective record					**20:30-31**	1484
	Incomplete record					**21:25**	

Events that Occurred Shortly After the Ascension

	Matthias Chosen to Replace Judas	"In those days"				**Acts 1:15-26**	1483
	The Coming of the Holy Spirit	Pentecost Sunday, 10 days after the ascension[21]				**Acts 2:1-13**	1486
	Peter (and others) preach	9 a.m.		**16:20**		**Acts 2:14-41**	

Background Information

Most of this chronology follows that in *The Narrated Bible* by F. LaGard Smith, though I have made some adjustments of my own. (See Aschmann.net/BibleChronology/#Sources for more information.) The page numbers in the last column of the table are from that book. (When I have significantly changed the order these are marked in green.)

However, Smith never explains which Gospel Harmony he followed, and in fact he has graciously explained to me that after 35 years he no longer has his original notes and cannot remember. I still consider his basic framework to be an excellent one and have mostly followed it, but recently for certain details I have come to rely on the monumental work *Baker's New Testament Commentary*, by William Hendriksen and Simon Kistemaker, the four gospels by Hendriksen.[22] He goes into great detail in explaining the sequence of many events. For this reason, and because I had unnecessarily summarized several sections, in June, 2020 I went into greater detail about many events, especially in the book of Luke, which has more unique material than Matthew or Mark, and rearranged some of these based on Hendriksen's logic. I also added information on the Five Discourses of Jesus in Matthew.

In any case this chronology should not be viewed as authoritative or inspired, but only as a helpful arrangement of the four gospels to show their relative chronology, using the key events marked with †, as shown below. Others have also made arrangements that are equally well thought through. However, the 3½-year framework seems to be the general consensus (see this page), as well as many of the details included here (see this page).

Colors, Formatting, and Symbols

Red text	A key date or timespan provided in the text, or that can be calculated from it. The text that provides it is also in red. A few events cannot be dated, but are key in determining the order of other events, like the imprisonment of John the Baptist or his execution; these are also marked in red.
Purple text	Other time information provided in the text, or that can be calculated from it, such as "the next day" or "on a Sabbath". This information is only relative, showing the time between two or more events, even though these cannot be dated in the larger context. (Note that before the beginning of Jesus' ministry and from the last week of his ministry onwards, all time information is colored red, not purple, since all of this time information is key and is datable in the larger context.)
†	This symbol indicates key events that allow us to construct this chronology, and to align the four gospels into one chronology. The **synoptic gospels** (Matthew, Mark, and Luke) tend to cover the same events and teaching, whereas John tends to cover quite different events and teaching, which makes it a bit difficult to align the synoptics with John. Even so, because of the few times they do cover the same events it is possible to develop this chronology.
Orange line in left margin	This shows the extent of what is known as the **Great Galilean Ministry**, which lasted about a year and a half, from around December of the year 27 until after Passover in the year 29. During this period Jesus spent most of his time in Galilee, and his ministry was very public.

Formatting of References in Columns 4 through 7

Bold and outlined	The most complete or key passage, or a passage with important additional information.
Blue outline	A passage outside of the four gospels that provides further information within the context of the four gospels.
Yellow background	A passage that is not in chronological order in one of the gospels (or at least that *The Narrated Bible* organized in a different order). Mark and John seem to be almost entirely chronological, but often Matthew is not, and sometimes Luke is not. (In each case when Mark and John do not agree, a choice has been made to follow one or the other. However, these conflicts only occur in **The Last Week of the Ministry of Jesus**, and mostly represent quite minor variations, except where clarified by a footnote.)
Sky-blue background	A passage that is placed out of order merely for organizational reasons, not because of any real chronological problem.
(in parentheses)	A passage that actually occurs elsewhere, but which provides information about an event which it does not directly narrate.

[grey and in brackets]	A passage that might appear to be a parallel passage, but which was probably a separate event or a repeated teaching. The context is what normally indicates this. (I have not included these exhaustively, since Jesus frequently taught similar things, and they would not all fit in this chart. I have only included some of the more obviously similar repeated teachings.)[23]
Thick green line at top of reference	Indicates a place where chronological order was followed, except that one or more passages with a yellow background or a sky-blue background were moved elsewhere, leaving a nonsequential break.[24]

Endnotes:

[1] The return from Egypt occurred after the death of Herod the Great, who most likely died in March or April of 4 B.C. If Jesus' ministry began in early 27 A.D., this makes his age right at 30, as stated in Luke 3:23, if we assume that he was born not long before that. Remember, there is no year 0! However, many commentators have assumed that the two-year figure in Matthew 2:16 means that Jesus was already two years old by the time of the arrival of the wise men, and that the phrase "about thirty years of age" in Luke 3:23 could mean up to 32. On the other hand, many other commentators, including such well-respected ones as *Baker's New Testament Commentary* and Alfred Edersheim, have said that we need not assume this, and that it fits the character of the wicked king Herod to have gone overboard in his killing of the infants. As *Baker's New Testament Commentary* says, "When it came to killing, Herod always allowed himself a very wide margin." For this reason I have simply said that Jesus was probably born sometime between 6 and 4 B.C.

[2] See this page, this page, and this page for why the time frame mentioned in Luke 3:1 for the start of John's ministry would have occurred in the latter part of 26 A.D.

[3] And possibly also John, who may have been the other disciple who is not named. See footnote 18. These are 3 of the four fishermen who receive a more "official" call later on at the Sea of Galilee (Lake Gennesaret), mentioned only in the Synoptic Gospels. See Apostles.html.

[4] According to John 2:20 this occurred 46 years after Herod the Great began reconstructing the temple, which occurred in the 18th year of his reign (20-19 B.C.), which confirms that Jesus began his ministry and cleared the temple in 27 A.D., which is also indicated from several other evidences. (Remember, there is no year 0!)

[5] *Baker's New Testament Commentary* points out that the Luke account here is quite different from the Matthew and Mark accounts, and suggests a prior acquaintance and that this is a later event. This also avoids assuming that Luke recounted this event out of order, as *The Narrated Bible* does.

[6] In John 5 the text does not say that this was the Passover, only that "there was a feast of the Jews, and Jesus went up to Jerusalem." There were three feasts that could only be celebrated in Jerusalem: Passover (in April), Pentecost (in June), and Tabernacles (in September or October), and this could have been any of these. *Baker's New Testament Commentary* says, "our opinion [is] that this unnamed feast a. was one of the three pilgrim feasts; b. must be dated in the year 28 A.D.; and c. was, *in all probability*, either Passover or feast of Tabernacles (without ruling out the possibility that it was Pentecost). In favor of the Passover two additional arguments are sometimes presented: 1. this is supported by the tradition of Irenaeus, and 2. this was the only feast which the Israelites were required to attend. However, the evidence is not entirely conclusive." This would put John 5 right before Luke 6, which happened in the spring at the wheat or barley harvest in April or May (see also endnote 8 below). The dating of John 4 and John 6 is much clearer, since these can be calibrated with the other gospels, with about a year and 4 months between them. Contributor Vince Eilenberger asked me to clarify this, and I know that others have had the same question. Thanks, Vince!

[7] This case is difficult. For various reasons these passages in Matthew, Mark, and Luke all seem to clearly connect with their own context, so in spite of the similarities, we must assume that the Luke case was a repeat of the Mark and Matthew teaching.

[8] In the climate of Israel the grass is only green and fresh during the springtime, mainly April. In the winter it freezes, and in the hot, dry summer it dries out. This confirms John's statement that it was near the Passover, and his statement that there was "plenty of grass" (John 6:10). See this excellent YouTube video about the four seasons in Israel from one of my favorite YouTube channels, Sergio & Rhoda in Israel, who bring to us in living color so many Biblical places.

[9] Before 10-Sep.-2019 I had placed the end of the Great Galilean Ministry later, at Mark 10:1a, but multiple commentators place it here, including *Baker's New Testament Commentary*. Jesus does return to Galilee after this, but his ministry is more private from this point on.

[10] In October, 2019, I moved this line up to follow Mark's order, since this is the only time *The Narrated Bible* does not follow Mark except when there is a conflict with John's order. (See the discussion at Yellow background above.)

[11] Perea is the region east of the Jordan and south of the Decapolis. Unlike the Decapolis, it was a mainly Jewish region, and like Galilee, it was ruled by Herod Antipas. It is never mentioned by name in the Bible, but it was "the region of Judea beyond the Jordan" mentioned in Matthew 19:1 and Mark 10:1, and was where Bethany beyond the Jordan was, mentioned directly in John 1:28 and indirectly in John 10:40. There was clearly a "Ministry in Perea", which would include at the very least Matthew 19:1-20:16, Mark 10:1-31, and John 10:40-42, and because of parallels with Matthew and Mark, Luke 18:15-30 as well. However, a number of commentators, including *Baker's New Testament Commentary* and *The Narrated Bible*, assume that Luke 13:22 also indicates this same period, since it says, "He went on his way through towns and villages, teaching and journeying toward Jerusalem." The normal route for Jews travelling from Galilee to Judea was through Perea, so as to avoid Samaria, and this would fit with the other gospels. This leaves the question of how much of Luke 12:1-18:14 to include: much of this material is unique to Luke, and what is not unique appear to be more likely repeated teaching rather than true parallel passages (see [grey and in brackets] above). *Baker's New Testament Commentary* suggests that most of it could probably be included here, and I have followed their lead.

[12] In April, 2021 I realized that the probability is that this passage terminates the Ministry in Perea, since Jesus does not return to Perea afterwards, so I moved it to its current position.

[13] There is a complication in these three parallel passages: Matthew and Mark say that Jesus healed the blind men as he was leaving Jericho, but Luke says that it was as he was entering. Many explanations for this have been put forth, but *Baker's New Testament Commentary* simply says, «The best answer is, There is a solution, for this "Scripture," too, is inspired. However, *we do not now have the solution to these problems*.» *The Narrated Bible* had changed Luke's order, but since this does not really resolve the issue, I have restored it.

[14] This appears to be the only case of a serious change of order on the part of Mark, in which he takes a time out from his account of the events of Tuesday afternoon to relate an event that evidently occurred three days earlier, on Saturday. John clearly places this event on Saturday, and the three accounts must refer to the same event, since so many of the details match. Why both Matthew and Mark place this event in this context is not totally clear, but many commentators confirm that this is what they have done, including *Baker's New Testament Commentary*.

[15] Because of its parallelism with the Matthew passage, *Baker's New Testament Commentary* presumes that Luke placed this out of order because of its subject matter, and this seems logical.

[16] Tradition has always said that the Lord's supper took place on Thursday of Holy Week and that Jesus was crucified on Friday and was resurrected on Sunday. This necessarily means that Wednesday is not mentioned, presumably as a rest day for Jesus. However, in Matthew 12:40 Jesus says, "For just as Jonah was three days and three nights in the belly of the great fish, so will the Son of Man be three days and three nights in the heart of the earth." This has led some interpreters, including F. LaGard Smith in *The Narrated Bible*, on which I have based most of my chronology, to say that Jesus must have been crucified on Thursday. However, I find that most commentators, including the *Wycliffe Bible Commentary*, *Baker's New Testament Commentary*, and most of these commentators, adhere to the traditional view, and give good arguments for this view, but I do not have space to include their arguments here. Up until October, 2019 I had partially followed F. LaGard Smith in his interpretation; at that time I rearranged or simplified a number of items, mostly following the *Wycliffe Bible Commentary* and *Baker's New Testament Commentary*, all adjustments marked with this footnote number [16].

[17] In May, 2019, I significantly rearranged the material in the **Lord's Supper** section, mostly following *Baker's New Testament Commentary*. Before that my analysis had been highly inconsistent, with several redundancies and not really following *The Narrated Bible* or any other authority.

[18] John the apostle, author of the fourth gospel, never mentions himself by name in his gospel, except indirectly as one of the two "sons of Zebedee" in John 21:2, apparently to show humility. Instead, he apparently refers to himself in other ways, as tradition confirms. He is almost certainly the "disciple whom Jesus loved" in John 13:23-25, 19:26-27, 20:2-3, and 21:7,20. He is also probably the "disciple who testifies" in John 19:35 and 21:24. And in this role he is quite possibly the other disciple who is not named in John 1:35-40 and in John 18:15-16. See Apostles.html.

[19] In January, 2019, I significantly rearranged the material in the **Trial before the Jewish Authorities** section and the following section. See Peter's Three Denials of Jesus.

[20] These dark-green quotes are the "seven last words of Jesus on the cross".

[21] According to this page and many others, and general church tradition, Jesus rose from the dead on the Feast of Firstfruits, and the Day of Pentecost occurred 50 days after the Feast of Firstfruits, leaving 10 days from the ascension to Pentecost.

[22] In earlier versions of this article prior to March, 2021, I had said that Kistemaker did the four gospels, but I had confused the two authors!
[23] I have only included this information since June, 2020, as distinguished from actual parallel passages.
[24] I only added these lines in April, 2021, because I realized that these breaks were hard to found without them, especially in long sequences like Luke 12-18.